

Oscar Wilde - Dorian Gray

Extract

First it is Lord Henry who is talking

Aphorism → Beauty is a form of Genius → then other aphorisms → it is only shallow people...

Time is jealous of you → personification of time → his youth is compared to flowers, metaphors → also gold of your days

Lord Henry's philosophy of life is a new hedonism → the purpose of life is to follow pleasure only, and ignore morality and social rules

Henry says to Dorian that he is lucky to be young and handsome, but this will not be for ever → and he will be miserable, so he has to live his age fully

There is a dark prophecy → he will stab the painting and will die because of this

Dorian will exhibit the picture in his living room, but as he notices some changes in the picture, he moves it to his attic

Last statement is his fatal wish

Gothic element → something irrational dreadful happens

The night when Dorian dies, Dorian decides to live a different life → he wants to stop following pleasure → and after taking that decision, he climbs the stairs to the attic

He thinks that the portrait must have started changing → it has become a horrible old monstrous man → but the painting doesn't change, and a hypocritical sneer shows up → he didn't want to change really (maybe)

So he stabs the painting, and transforms in the hideous figure of the painting, while the painting returns to its original state

The servants recognize him only for his rings

British literature on WWI

The first world war is also called the great war → 1914 - 1918 → Italy joins in 1915
UK joins because:

- it needed to support its allies to Russia and France
- rivalry with Germany → it was a dangerous country because:
 - economical → UK was the richest and more industrialized country in the world → but Germany had become competition

- political →britain still had the most powerful colonial empire →but germany was building its empire in africa

The war started in 1914, until 1916 the british army was made only of volunteers →for two years, hundreds of thousands of young men decided to go to the front and fight for their country

Some of them did it out of patriotism, but most of them because they were convinced by pro-war propaganda

Pro-war propaganda worked through articles in newspapers and magazines →young people were invited to leave for the front in order not to look like cowards

There were sit-ins which were trying to convince young men to join the army →young men were stopped

They also gave those young men white feathers, symbol of cowardy →there was a lot of psychological pressure

There were also lots of posters →aim to convince young men to join the war

Britons want you

King of england is pointing to the reader →britons were a celtic population, that lived in england around 100 b.C. →they survived the roman invasion →in year 410 a.D. they regained independence from the roman empire, which ruled between 43 and 410 a.D.

450 a.D. anglosaxons attacked britain (a germanic population) →the populations migrated to wales →then anglosaxons and celtics started to merge

Propaganda did not want to consider the anglosaxons (germanic tribe) as the real ancestors of the english people →they wanted the celts, so they called britons

Take up the sword of justice

Personification of justice →it was honorable and just to join the war →young men had to fight for justice

Beat back the hun

Hun stands for "unni" →germans are compared to huns, that were a barbaric and violent tribe lead by Attila →germans are monsters and barbarians

It is a german soldier, painted as a monster and his hands dirty of blood of innocent people

Who's absent

A man wearing a ? with the uk flag →invites to enlist →and asks who is absent, not gone to the front

Father

Children ask their father what did he do during the WWI →plays on the sense of guilt

In 1916 volunteers were not enough, so all british men aged between 18 and 31 were obliged to enter the british army →conspiction was introduced